

NovaCart

Cancellation Policy

Document Type: Customer & Support Knowledge Base Policy

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Status: Active for Autonomous Customer Support Copilot Demo

Policy Area	Order cancellation and cancellation-related support
Applies To	NovaCart customer orders
General Cancellation Window	Before the order enters a non-cancellable fulfillment or shipment stage
Supported Region	India
Support Email	support@novacart.example
Support Hours	Monday–Sunday, 9:00 AM–9:00 PM IST

1. Purpose

This Cancellation Policy explains when a NovaCart customer may cancel an order, how cancellation eligibility depends on order status, what happens to prepaid and Cash on Delivery orders, and how cancellation-related refunds are handled.

The policy is intended to provide consistent guidance to customers and the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot. A cancellation request does not guarantee that an order can be cancelled; the current fulfillment stage must be checked.

2. General Cancellation Rule

Customers may generally request cancellation while the order remains in a cancellable stage.

Once an order has entered a non-cancellable fulfillment stage, such as shipment handover, cancellation may no longer be available through the normal process. In such cases, the customer may need to use the applicable return or delivery-resolution process after the order reaches the customer.

The exact cancellation option shown to a customer should be based on the current order status.

3. Order Status and Cancellation

Cancellation eligibility can depend on the following stages:

- Order placed — cancellation is generally available if the system allows it.
- Payment processing — cancellation may depend on whether the payment has been captured and whether the order can still be stopped.
- Order confirmed — cancellation may remain available before fulfillment progresses.
- Processing/packing — cancellation may be limited depending on fulfillment status.
- Shipped — normal cancellation may no longer be available.
- Out for delivery — cancellation is generally not available through the standard cancellation flow.
- Delivered — cancellation is no longer applicable; an eligible return process may apply instead.

4. How to Request Cancellation

Customers should use the cancellation option associated with the order when it is available.

A typical process is:

1. Open the customer account.
2. Open the relevant order.
3. Select the cancellation option.
4. Select an available cancellation reason.
5. Confirm the cancellation request.
6. Check the order status for confirmation.

If the cancellation option is not available, the customer should not assume that support can cancel the order manually. Support should first verify the current order stage.

5. Cancellation Before Fulfillment

If a customer requests cancellation before the order enters a non-cancellable stage, NovaCart may stop further processing and record the order as cancelled.

For prepaid orders, any eligible refund is handled according to the Refund Policy after the payment and cancellation status are verified.

For COD orders, cancellation normally means that no payment needs to be collected for the cancelled order, subject to the actual order status.

6. Cancellation During Processing

Orders that are being packed or prepared may have limited cancellation availability because fulfillment activities may already have started.

If the system still allows cancellation, the customer can follow the normal cancellation process. If cancellation is no longer available, support should explain that the order has progressed beyond the standard cancellation stage and provide the appropriate next step.

7. Cancellation After Shipment

Once an order has been handed over for shipment, standard cancellation may no longer be available.

Customers should not be promised that a shipped order can be cancelled. Depending on the order and product conditions, the customer may need to receive the product and then request an eligible return under the Return Policy.

Any prepaid amount should be handled according to the applicable payment, return, and refund rules.

8. Cancellation for Cash on Delivery Orders

For eligible COD orders, cancellation before delivery generally prevents the payment from being collected.

If the COD order has already entered a non-cancellable delivery stage, the customer should follow the applicable delivery or return instructions rather than assuming that cancellation is still possible.

Support should check the order status before confirming any cancellation.

9. Cancellation for Prepaid Orders

For prepaid orders, cancellation can involve a refund when the order is successfully cancelled and payment has been captured.

Support should distinguish between:

- Cancellation requested — customer has asked to cancel.
- Cancellation confirmed — NovaCart has successfully cancelled the order.
- Refund initiated — an eligible refund process has been started.
- Refund completed — the payment provider has completed the refund.

The AI assistant should not tell a customer that money has been refunded unless the refund status is confirmed.

10. Cancellation Because of Customer Error

If a customer accidentally ordered the wrong product, quantity, size, or address, the customer should request cancellation as soon as possible.

Cancellation is subject to the current order stage. If cancellation is no longer available, the customer may need to use the applicable return process after delivery, provided the product qualifies for return.

11. Cancellation Due to Duplicate Order

If a customer accidentally places the same order more than once, the customer should identify the duplicate order as soon as possible.

Support should verify the order numbers and current statuses. If one order can still be cancelled, the normal cancellation process should be followed. Any eligible refund for a prepaid cancelled order is handled according to the Refund Policy.

12. Cancellation Due to NovaCart Fulfillment Issues

NovaCart may cancel an order when it cannot fulfill the order due to circumstances such as inventory problems, operational restrictions, or other fulfillment issues.

When NovaCart cancels a prepaid order, the applicable refund process should be initiated after payment verification. Customers should receive clear information about the cancellation and next steps.

The AI assistant should not invent a specific reason for a company-initiated cancellation if the actual reason is not available in the retrieved information.

13. Cancellation and Refund Relationship

Cancellation and refund are separate events.

A cancelled order does not necessarily mean that the refund has already been completed. For prepaid orders, the payment must be reviewed and an eligible refund may then be initiated.

The Refund Policy defines refund processing and status terminology. The Payment Policy defines payment verification and payment-status handling.

14. Cancellation Exceptions

A cancellation request may require additional review when:

- The order status is inconsistent across systems.
- Payment was deducted but the order status is unresolved.
- The order is already in shipment.

- The customer disputes a cancellation outcome.
- A company-initiated cancellation requires payment reconciliation.
- The order involves a special product or restricted fulfillment condition.

The AI assistant should escalate rather than guess when the available policy and order information do not establish the correct outcome.

15. Cancellation Ticket and Escalation

A general question such as “Can I cancel my order?” can normally be answered using the policy and current order status.

A support ticket or human escalation may be appropriate when:

- The cancellation button is unavailable but the customer believes the order is still cancellable.
- The cancellation was confirmed but the refund is unresolved.
- The order status is contradictory or unavailable.
- A prepaid payment needs reconciliation.
- A customer disputes a cancellation.
- A company-initiated cancellation requires investigation.

16. Information Required for Cancellation Support

Support may request non-sensitive information such as:

- Order number.
- Product or order description.
- Reason for cancellation.
- Current order status, if visible to the customer.
- Payment reference, when a prepaid payment issue is involved.

Customers should not provide passwords, OTPs, PINs, or confidential payment credentials.

17. Examples

Example 1 — Early cancellation:

Customer: “I just placed the order and want to cancel it.”

Expected handling: Check whether the order is still cancellable and guide the customer through the cancellation process.

Example 2 — Shipped order:

Customer: “My order has shipped but I want to cancel it.”

Expected handling: Explain that normal cancellation may no longer be available and provide the applicable return/delivery next step.

Example 3 — Cancelled prepaid order:

Customer: “My order was cancelled but I haven’t received my money.”

Expected handling: Distinguish cancellation from refund, verify the payment/refund status when available, and escalate if transaction investigation is required.

Example 4 — COD cancellation:

Customer: "I ordered something with Cash on Delivery and want to cancel."

Expected handling: Check the order stage. If cancellable, guide the customer through cancellation; if already in a non-cancellable delivery stage, explain the available next step.

18. Relationship With Other Policies

This Cancellation Policy works together with the Payment Policy, Refund Policy, Return Policy, and Product & Order Policy.

The Cancellation Policy determines whether an order can be cancelled. The Payment Policy explains payment status. The Refund Policy explains eligible refunds after cancellation. The Return Policy applies when a delivered product needs to be returned.

19. Policy Authority

This document is the authoritative general cancellation-policy source for the NovaCart customer-support knowledge base.

The Autonomous Customer Support Copilot should use the customer's current order status together with this policy when responding to cancellation questions. If the system cannot establish the order stage or payment status, the issue should be escalated rather than resolved by assumption.

This document is fictional and created exclusively for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot project.